

32 Which statement concerning events that occur in the heart is correct?

- A** As the wave of excitation passes through the atrioventricular node there is a time delay before it passes down the conducting fibres in the septum to the ventricles; this allows the atria to fill before ventricular systole.
- B** Contraction of the ventricle muscles following atrial systole causes the ventricular blood pressure to rise above the blood pressure in the atria, closing the atrioventricular valve and preventing backflow.
- C** The band of non-conducting fibres between the atria and ventricles prevents the wave of excitation from the atria reaching the ventricles directly; the wave of excitation passes to the Purkyne fibres and then to the atrioventricular node.
- D** The primary pacemaker, the sinoatrial node in the left atrium, sends out a wave of excitation that spreads across the walls of the atria, resulting in the movement of blood from the atria into the ventricles.